

VIP NOTEBOOK

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January 14, 2025: First Meeting with VIP

- This was the first meeting with the VIP. I learned about all the different groups. It was very interesting to see how all of the groups fit together to create the whole product. The diagram of the groups interacting together was very helpful to see what part of the app each group deals with.
- The arrows led to each other, showing the groups' connections. I would like to join the facilitating interactions group because of how this group works to nudge people throughout their time on the app, not just in the beginning. I also like the idea of working with AI to create certain features, such as the ice breaker.
- Next meeting we will finalize what group we are part of and what our prototype is.

January 21, 2025 - Prototyping Discussion

- This meeting we decided the prototype each group would be making. I learned what an MVP (minimal viable product) is and got an idea of what it would like. For our group, we are deciding on making a working way to present ice breakers to the users, for either when they first join or when they have not communicated with each other for a while.

- We also met as a group after class to discuss what we want to make for our prototype, how we will go about doing this, and what needs to be set up. I saw how as this is only an MVP, we can make a simple text like product, without focusing too much on the front end. I like the idea of incorporating an AI to determine which prompt to give the user.
- I am going to be looking into how we can incorporate AI APIs into our code in order to create this.
- Here are the notes from the meeting:

Slack Huddle Call Meeting (1/21)

Main action items for the project as a whole:

- Working on project backend
- Working on frontend in Figma (completed at a later date – possibly after demo is due)

More Discussion on Backend

- Different tasks to be divided up for group members:
 - Creating the prompt to generate icebreakers with GPT
 - Manually creating the personalities of the two hardcoded people
 - Basic demographic factors: hobbies, major/minor, year, when they like to study, remote/in person/where they prefer to study, times they are free
 - Connecting the prompt to the GPT API key
 - More on inputting side of backend
 - Calling the API and pushing the output out on the terminal for user to view

More Discussion on Frontend:

- Figma can be done at a later time
- We can use hardcoded users if we aren't able to get real users from Identifying Connections in time
- Figma doesn't have to be very serious, working backend code is what matters

January 28, 2025 - Prototyping and Testing

- Discussion on questions about prototyping for our subteam, including what we need to do for testing.
- It's important for our group to have the same vision going forward and also as an individual know what tasks need to be completed to advance our group's goals.
- Some questions from our main document::

How will AI be used to facilitate interactions?

- We want to use Generative AI technologies like a ChatGPT API to help listen in on a conversation and provide icebreakers.
- The AI will use data entered by the individuals to facilitate personalized interactions.

What data will the prototype use to facilitate interactions that are appropriate for the individuals involved?

- This is an example for the kind of data we need. We could potentially work with Identifying connections to add any specific questions etc, once we get working with the API and start prompt analysis.
- `name": "Alice",
"gender": "Female",
"year": "Sophomore",
"minor": "Business",
"location": "Remote",
"interests": ["Soccer", "Cooking", "Reading"]`
- Feedback:
 - We should focus on testing the quality of our ice breakers.
 - A good way to do this is to have users time how long they were able to have a conversation given an ice breaker.

- My individual work for the week: Generate code for how to create an AI prompt given the dummy data that will create a quality icebreaker. Also, start creating the figma to have a foundation of what it will look like.

February 4, 2025 - Speaker Notes & Prototype Development

- Speaker notes:
- MVP mindset
- Required data, obtained through, stored in
 - Required: Age, Location, user Picture, etc.
 - Obtained through: User submission
 - Stored in: Supabase
- Design
 - Build in Figma, then export everywhere
 - Ceratewithplay.com
 - Good way to display your prototype, lets you use ios apps
 - Use something that is simple and supported because it's easy to find support for.
- Building
 - AI
 - Groq: get an API token and use their API

- Jitter: Makes motion designs
- Label Studio: Microtask data labelling
- 2 most recommended tools: PostHog - Analytics, Hail - Community forum
- Marketing
 - Building stuff that might be complex, but keep it as simple as possible
 - Ex.: Timeleft - simple form to find people to eat dinner with.
- What are prototypes:
 - They are tangible manifestations.
 - Test concepts, identify problems, and get feedback early on
- Prototype testing:
 - Think in terms of technical complexity and design requirements
 - Low fidelity user prototype
 - Low design requirements, low technical complexity
 - Questions asked: Do you need a button, do you have the right data?
 - High fidelity user prototypes
 - High design requirements, low technical complexity
 - Questions asked: Is that spelled right, is that a good color?
 - Feasibility prototypes

- Low design requirements, high technical complexity
 - Questions asked: Is this even possible, does this work?
- Functional, Live data prototypes
 - High design requirements, high technological complexity
 - Testing functionality proven with data.
- For next week:
 - Internal demo: show what you have done and what you still need to do
 - Test plan: how can you test what you have done so far to reach where you want to be for the end of the semester.
- I am working on finishing up the prototype and creating the slides for the demo. I have to finish up the Figma model, and I am also going to help with creating the prompt for generating the ice breakers. This has been taking a lot of testing to refine and get the right prompt.

February 11, 2025 - Prototype Presentations

- This meeting we presented all our prototypes.
- The feedback for our group:
 - The AI should automatically generate a response rather than a user having to press the “Generate Ice Breaker” button.

- Look more into the color purple and if the only emotion we want to generate is calmness. Purple can also be generated with other emotions.
- Look more into how we can test all aspects of our prototype with everything from the colors used to the ice breakers.
- Connections Group:
 - They have a UI that is GT themed. The user can login or signup and fill out a form. The user will then have a screen with potential matches they can choose.
 - The prototype includes an algorithm to generate groups of different sizes with user input.
 - They have a prototype algorithm to generate personality types from given text. This can be used to find better matches among people.
 - It would be nice if our group and their group coordinated our dummy data so we were basing our algorithms off of the same data.
 - It would also be good for both our groups to have the same UI, so our Figma UIs flow together.
- Managing Resources Group:
 - They have an AI that analyzes how good a post is on a given topic.
 - Sentiment Analysis

- Evaluates effectiveness on a user response
 - Users can comment on other user's posts, and they have created an algorithm to rank the comments.
 - A prototype with an AI that gives a quality rating to a user's response to answering other users questions.
- Our goal for next time is to come up with a test plan. I will work on the test plan, and I will be creating one of the forms so that we can get feedback from our peers on our prototype.

February 18, 2025 - Refining Test Plan

- Today we went over the test plan we had worked on this week. We responded to the comments left on our plan in order to refine our test plan further and decide how we can improve it and begin testing for the next two weeks.
- Our test plan was unclear with what is meant by testing for "correct" prompts. We clarified this, and when we say we are testing for "correctness" we mean accurately that the ice breaker uses the profiles' details and interests. This will help us in understating the quality of the icebreakers and if we need to improve upon our prompt generation. We also clarified that

people completing the form should be ranking the ice breakers based on if they would like receiving it but also based on their personal opinions.

- We decided that before we start testing, we need to add a few more questions to the existing form and also create a new form to test the UI, which should include some questions on the colors, sizes, and flow of our existing Figma model.
- My individual work: Create the UI testing form since we do not currently have this and it would be useful to have different forms for the frontend and backend. I will also begin to ask people to fill out both forms to collect data.

February 25, 2025 - Test Plan Progress Discussion

- In addition to our existing code, we have added a statistics file that will collect the number of times someone closes out or hits the “x” button when an ice breaker is presented to them. Once we are able to add a front end this will help to collect data about how effective our ice breakers are.
- So far, we have asked some people to fill out our forms and have gotten some data. We are seeing some mixed results about how people feel about our ice breakers and how well they reflect the people they are meant for.
- In the upcoming week, I need to ask more people to fill out the forms. I will also come up with my ideas for how I think we can improve the prototype

based on the results we see. I will also be putting together a presentation to present our findings and next steps for next week.

March 4, 2025 - Test Results Presentation

- Today, we presented the results after our testing.
- Results we got:
 - UI: We need to fix the proportions of our UI, make it the size of a mobile app, which should fix the size of all its buttons. We would like to have a theme for the front end that we decide on all together as a class to make this uniform, instead of trying to move forward with our purple theme.
 - AI Generation: The icebreakers are not as engaging as they would be if they would have been about our classes. Oftentimes, the generated prompt is not as personalized or tries to weirdly combine two different hobbies. We need to refine our prompt generation to make icebreakers more engaging and personalized.
- Feedback from our presentation:
 - We should make prompts based on both hobbies and classes.
 - It is difficult to combine some of these hobbies.

- We should have our prompt generated based on information of what classes the users are in, rather than their hobbies.
 - We need to gather more information from the user to do this.
- Users should be able to choose a different prompt that is based on their hobbies or classes if they don't like the current type of prompt they are given.
- We can reuse our slide for future presentations to show our before and after.
- We should combine having a bank of icebreakers and generating them on the fly.
 - We can generate icebreakers using our prompt if the user requests for a new prompt, otherwise we can give them one from our bank of prompts, which should have prompts that we have tested for having high engagement.
- Based on this feedback, I will work on fixing our frontend. I will also help with fixing our icebreaker generation and refine the prompt some more.

March 11, 2025 - Planning for Final Presentation

- Goals for Refining our Prototype:

- Create a better prompt that will generate prompts that are more focused on the users' classes, rather than more on their interests.
- Refine the dummy data that we are using, so that we are collecting more about the user's classes and study behavior.
 - Major, minor, classes, credits, class sections, where you like to study
- We want to generate an introduction for the people in the group before giving the ice breaker for them.
 - The introductory blurb will introduce the people to each other with the similarities between the people.
- We want to update the ice breaker feedback form based on the new prompt
 - Get more feedback on our form based on the new prompt.
- Get the AI to connect meeting times when both people are free.
- Update the size of the Figma. It should be the dimensions of a mobile app, so the outline size and buttons should be fixed.
- To do for this me week: Update the prompt to be more focused on classes and create a rough prompt for the introductions. Also, connect with the other group for the Figma theme, and then update ours.

March 25, 2025 - Progress and Guest Speaker

- Progress so far towards demo
 - We have coordinated with the other group on the theme for the frontend, so we are updating our Figma model to be uniform with their theme.
 - We have updated the algorithm so that we can have better prompt generation that is more focused on user's classes.
 - We also now have the AI present a blurb about each person in their classes, so that they get to know each other better.
 - We are starting to record data on how many times the "x" is clicked versus how many times the ice breaker is accepted.
 - We want to get more responses on our form, now that we have the new prompt that is focused on user interests.
 - When the "x" is clicked, the new prompt is not too different from the original, so we want to improve that.
- Guest speaker
- Transactive memory
 - Who knows what. On a team, you know who has expertise in different areas, so they can lead those areas.
- AI can help with speaking up within teams. There is a bias towards people who are the loudest, rather than those who know the most.

- Transactive memory systems increase trust within a team and with the intelligent assistant.
- The use of AI will increase performance, but as soon as that is taken away, the performance goes down. This suggests that teams are not able to adapt.
- Collective intelligence - at the team level and the organizational level.
 - Creating strategies for teams, and also teams of teams.
- I will continue working on the frontend and also look into how we can work on the concept of keeping a bank of questions for when the “x” is clicked.

April 1, 2025 - Planning for Demo and Presentation

- Today, we discussed what we will be putting in our presentation and our action plan for the next week.
- We would like to update our Figma to make the theme better and improve the quality and size of all the elements.
- We want to update our slides and figure out who is saying what.
- We want to create personas that we use across all the groups.
- For next week:
 - We will add to the final presentation.
 - We will also finish the final UI with the personas.

- We will also try to update the prompt to be more refined. When the “x” button is pressed, the prompt generates a new very similar ice breaker. We may want to create a bank of questions to use in this case instead.
- We will try getting more responses on our testing forms with the updated versions.
- I will work on the Figma, the presentation, and help with creating the bank of questions for the code.

April 8, 2025 - Working on Demo

- We went over the current slides we have.
- We worked on the slides, and changed them up. We wanted a new theme for our slides, so we created that.
- For next week:
 - We will make our final changes to the UI and code.
 - They both need to include the new personas we decided on as a class. The Figma needs to have its flow fixed now that the theme is changed. We can continue working on creating a question bank for the code.

- We will finish up the presentation and create the final demo video that will be shown to the audience. We plan on having a video for the code, but then walking through the Figma in person to create a more immersive experience.
- We will practice the presentation before class.
- I will finish the frontend and finish the slides for our presentation.

April 15, 2025 - Final Demo Presentations

- Today, we presented our final demos.
 - Before this, we finished our slide presentation, and tied together our frontend and backend by using our personas.
- Other groups presentations:
 - Identifying connections:
 - UI group - got feedback about the survey looking crowded and using a lettuce meet style. They updated their UI with this, so it is less cluttered and has new questions in their survey.
 - Grouping algorithm - they did not gather the right characteristics at first about the user, so they changed this, along with the group size. They also have added a weightage for each characteristic.

- AI Module - they use text analysis about each person to identify personality types that will be used to help group people.
- Managing resources:
- Used syllabus and users notes with an LLM to create tagging.
- They use a feedback on notes to see something that would pass or does not pass, based on how likely another student is to find the notes useful. Rubric scores and descriptions provide what is good about the resource and what its limitations are.
- Questions/feedback on our presentation:
 - Evaluate the quality of combining both the professor and student notes (for managing resources group).
 - Does asking about the student's classes take away from the social aspect of the application instead of asking about the student's interests?
 - We changed this based on feedback from our testing.
 - We should generate icebreakers based off of the previous conversations that were already happening to make it more relevant to the study group that the question is being asked to.